

Kingston's Data Traveller II Plus Migo Edition

Working Was Never Easier

Here's an easier way to carry your work—the Kingston Data Traveller II plus migo edition. The concept of this USB 2.0 Flash Drive is to store your PC's settings and then give you the freedom to work on different computers in different locations, using your own machine's Microsoft Outlook contents, Internet Explorer settings, favourites and history, plus your files and folders.

The 'Main Computer' is the primary computer on which you would normally save most of your files and a 'Guest Computer' is any other desktop or laptop that you would temporarily access. The whole idea is to personalise the Guest Computer to look and feel like your Main Computer. All this is possible thanks to the implementation of 'migo'.

Migo helps you synchronise the Main Computer into the Flash drive, and then allows the customising of a Guest Computer to look like your desktop. Migo also saves your Internet Explorer settings, Microsoft Outlook contents, Desktop settings, and of any other file.

Kingston also provides software known as the SecureTraveller, which is a configuration utility program

that works on Windows, allowing users to set up a public and a password protected privacy zone within the Flash drive. The privacy zone is invisible to Windows, and it can only be accessed by entering a password. It therefore provides powerful data security for home and office use.

On the 512 MB version we tested, transfer of 100 MB of assorted files and a single file was timed at 15 seconds and 6 seconds respectively. Results of the SiSoft Sandra test were also positive, with sequential read and write speeds of 26 Mbps and 19 Mbps respectively.

All in all, the DataTraveller II plus is a fast USB Flash drive that offers data-securing capabilities and the option to synchronise your data with any Windows-based machine anywhere in the world.

Company **A A Infoways**

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Rating



New & Notable

Sony PlayStation2

Gamers Rejoice!

Unlike in most parts of the world, console gaming is still in its infancy in India. It has been limited to Nintendo clones such as the Little Master, which were popular in the early '90s.

With Sony and Microsoft having launched their respective consoles last year, it was time for a change! Since the launch of the PlayStation in the US and Japan back in 2000, Sony has sold an astounding 90 million units.

The PlayStation2 is an incredibly slim-and-slick black box. There's an Ethernet port for games, which supports online multiplayer gaming. It has two memory card slots to save game states and configurations. But Sony's decision to stick with Magic Gate (its proprietary data encryption technology) is irritating, as it prevents you from using any standard memory card format with the console.

The PS2 can even play PS1 games, and doubles up as a CD/DVD player. And the Dolby Digital surround sound support will foil an enemy soldier's attempt to take you by surprise from behind!

At the heart of the PS2 lies the powerful Emotion Engine, a 128-bit CPU with integrated graphics processing capabilities. Sony designed this souped-up rig keeping in mind its primary function of simulating 3D environments. We played a few games on it and were totally floored—menu

backgrounds are incredibly dynamic, simulated fog looks like the real thing, transparency effects are invoked regularly, human faces are life-like, and Batman's cape casts an unearthly shadow.

The PS2's massive game library includes such best-selling titles as *Tony Hawk Pro Skater*,

Grand Theft Auto, *Final Fantasy*,

Burnout and *Metal Gear Solid*. Titles such as the genre-defining *Gran Turismo 4* (700 different cars ranging from Ford Model T to Nissan Skyline, over 50 racetracks, and real-life physics) and the *Katamari Damacy* have catapulted the PS2 to the top of a gamer's wish-list.

Sadly, Sony doesn't include a memory card, a second controller or a game with the package. While the PS2 is available in the US for as low as \$130 (Rs 5,850), it's selling in India for almost double that price. And with the next generation of consoles—the Xbox 360 and the PS3—only months away, this price is not justified.

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Rating

